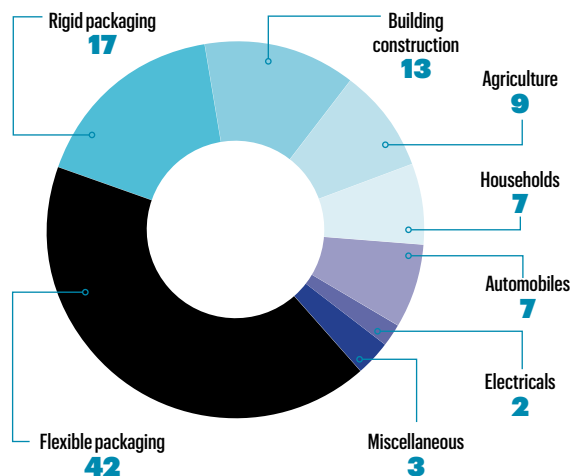


MARKET MIX

IN THE VALUE CHAIN OF PLASTICS, MIDSTREAM PLAYERS USE RAW PLASTICS TO MAKE A VARIETY OF GOODS RANGING FROM PACKAGING TO CONSTRUCTION AND HOUSEHOLD ITEMS



SOURCE MARICO INNOVATION FOUNDATION

There is also private and VC funding available that has helped in bringing innovative solutions to the fore, with brands adopting these solutions to reduce the overall problem of plastics,” he says.

MIF’s research has found that some of the most important aspects required in reducing the impact of plastics on the environment are finding sustainable ways to achieve circularity, eliminating waste at

the source, along with reusing and recycling plastic products and materials at scale, for which the foundation is working with over a dozen start-ups. But to achieve these goals, especially circularity, the report has found that funding has been insignificant, with just \$6 million invested in CY21. Compare that to the close to \$6 billion invested in edtech and another \$5 billion invested in fintech or the over \$1.2 billion in e-commerce and logistics, and the picture for the space becomes very gloomy. “MIF will work closely with the start-ups to identify the critical areas that prevent them from scaling up,” says Mariwala. Through the knowledge partners, the intention is to create a plan for each of their innovations to scale up. “They will then provide the necessary support in terms of connects, market access, mentorship and the opportunity to pitch to investors,” he points out.

COMBAT MODE

Tucked away in Goregaon, Mumbai, is Lucro Plaste-cycle that specialises in converting used plastics into final packaging products. “This is a tough business to be in and we have a model that is fully integrated,” says Pratibha Priya Dewett, Chief Sustainability Officer at the start-up that begins with collecting waste to sorting and cleaning it, to later recycling it into finished products. On her table are plastic bottles of Parachute coconut oil bound together in a stretch wrap (a stretchable plastic film wrapped around items). The wrap is made at the company’s factory in Gujarat’s Umargam, a three-hour drive from Mumbai. The start-up focuss-

PROBLEM

PVC (POLYVINYL CHLORIDE)

Bottle wrappers, tapes, takeaway packaging



PP (POLYPROPYLENE)

Microwave dishes, snack packets, ice cream tubs



PS (POLYSTYRENE)

CD cases, hot drink cups, foamed meat trays

